



We
test 23 scanners
across three price
categories to help you
choose the right scanner
for your needs

The Real picture on scanners

You plug in a scanner, throw a photo onto the glass, and push one button without even starting the software and hey presto! It's scanned! Scanners have become so user-friendly that almost anybody can use them. Plus, they are a great multipurpose tool for the office and for professionals. From putting images on the Web to digital data management, it's all possible.

Scanners are the link in our effort to digitise the analogue real life that we live: the average person wants a colour scanner for

photos, graphics or plain document scanning. A small to medium business enterprise might be looking for a scanner that can do fast black and white scanning which can later be OCR-ed into editable text. Graphic artists or desktop publishers and professional imaging studios might be looking for an ultra high-end, specialised, feature-packed photo scanner.

So how do you go about choosing a scanner? Is a 32-bit scanner better than a 36-bit scanner? Obvious? What about resolution? Do you need 600 dpi (dots per inch) or will 300 dpi do the trick? And what's this stuff about optical resolution versus